

International Business

The world has become a global marketplace. Large volumes of goods, services, ideas, money, and technology are transported throughout the world, affecting the lives of millions of people in the process. Today, virtually every aspect of economic activity is influenced by international business. As students explore the world of business and the opportunities and challenges that it presents, it is vital that they do so with an appreciation of the impact of the global marketplace and international trade. Through these courses, students will develop a fundamental understanding of the global economy. They will come to appreciate the impact that international business can have on their lives and communities today and on the careers and opportunities they are considering for the future. Through these courses, students will develop a broader and deeper understanding of international issues and concerns and begin to develop an informed awareness of those issues directly affecting their future careers.

Strands

International Business Fundamentals, Grade 12, University/College Preparation

- Business, Trade, and the Economy
- The Global Environment for Business
- Factors Influencing Success in International Markets
- Marketing Challenges and Approaches, and Distribution
- Working in International Markets

International Business Essentials, Grade 12, Workplace Preparation

- Canada in the Global Marketplace
- International Markets
- Conducting International Business
- International Careers and Skills

International Business Essentials, Grade 12, Workplace Preparation

(BBB4E)

This course provides an introduction to international business. Students will explore the economic relationships that Canada has developed with other nations, and the impact of these relationships on productivity, prices, and variety of goods. This course also introduces students to a variety of career opportunities in international business.

Prerequisite: None

Canada in the Global Marketplace

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the advantages, disadvantages, and challenges associated with international business activity;
- explain why Canadian companies have become involved in international business;
- describe the evolution of Canada's international business activities and relationships;
- determine how Canadians have been affected by international business activity.

Specific Expectations

The Importance of International Business

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the advantages (e.g., increased quantity and quality of products, decreased prices, technological developments) and disadvantages (e.g., loss of jobs, increased foreign ownership of Canadian companies) of international trade for Canada;
- identify the barriers to and challenges associated with international business activity (e.g., language, tariffs, currency fluctuations).
- identify Canada's current major trading partners and the products traded;
- describe how the Canadian government has worked to expand international business opportunities for Canadian companies (e.g., through trade missions, trade agreements);
- describe the impact of various trade agreements (e.g., Agreement on Internal Trade, North American Free Trade Agreement) and trade organizations (e.g., World Trade Organization, International Monetary Fund) on Canada's international business activity.

Reasons for Involvement in International Business

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain how other countries' needs and wants may present business opportunities for Canadian companies;
- explain how the needs and wants of Canadians may present opportunities for foreign companies;
- describe how international business can help Canadian businesses meet their goals (e.g., higher profits, greater economies of scale).

Changes in Canada's International Business Activity

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the types of international businesses (e.g., import/export, global sourcing, joint ventures, strategic alliances, wholly owned subsidiaries);

The Effects of International Business on Canada

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the effects of international business activity on economic conditions in Canada (e.g., on employment levels; quality, quantity, and variety of goods and services; productivity; prices; competition; technological development);
- describe the effects of foreign investment on Canada;
- identify both Canadian companies that are leaders at the international level and industries in which Canadian companies have had international success (e.g., biotechnology, telecommunications).

International Markets

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the ways in which a company can explore business opportunities in international markets;
- evaluate the challenges confronting the operation of an international business;
- demonstrate an understanding of the procedures to be followed and the factors to be considered in the import and export of goods and services.

Specific Expectations

Business Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the features of local, regional, national, and international markets;
- describe the factors influencing a company's participation in business opportunities in other countries (e.g., trade agreements, language barriers, currency fluctuations, geography);
- describe the ways in which a company can determine whether a potential market exists for its imports or exports.

Operational Challenges

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe how international businesses modify the characteristics and features of their products sold in different countries;
- describe the factors that may result in some countries producing higher-quality goods and others producing less-reliable goods (e.g., differences in production values, availability of skilled labour, working conditions, availability of technology, communications, difficulties when production unit and head office are located in different countries);

- describe the factors that influence a company's ability to compete internationally (e.g., cost of labour, availability of appropriate technology, quality of management, levels of efficiency, marketing skills).

Import and Export Considerations

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the factors that can influence a company's ability to import or export a product;
- demonstrate numeracy skills by converting a variety of international currencies to Canadian dollars;
- describe an export strategy for a Canadian product;
- compare successful and unsuccessful attempts by companies to import products to Canada and to export and market products to foreign countries;
- identify, using a variety of sources, including the Internet, several imported and exported products on which duties and tariffs are placed.

Conducting International Business

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of the way in which ethical considerations affect international business decisions;
- identify cultural differences between countries and describe how they affect international business practices;
- summarize the effects and challenges of marketing internationally;
- summarize the ways in which technology has affected international business.

Specific Expectations

Ethical Issues

By the end of this course, students will:

- compare the code of ethics for a variety of international companies;
- describe ways in which multinational enterprises have both positive and negative effects on the countries in which they operate;
- summarize the ethical issues that arise for companies that are competing internationally (e.g., fair wages, regulation of child labour, cultural preservation, environmental practices).

Culture and Customs

By the end of this course, students will:

- determine the cultural challenges and benefits for management of doing business internationally (e.g., language barriers, variations in work ethic and attitudes);
- identify key cultural differences between countries (e.g., language, religion, family structure) and describe how they create both opportunities and challenges for companies involved in international business;
- describe some of the features of Canadian culture, including diversity and multiculturalism, and explain how they can be an advantage in doing business internationally (e.g., the range of experience, skills, languages

in a diverse workforce; international contacts and knowledge of local customs in other countries);

- compare Canadian business protocol (e.g., laws, customs) with that of another country;
- compare communication preferences (e.g., choice of media, tone, symbolism, body language, gestures) in Canada with those of other countries.

International Marketing

By the end of this course, students will:

- compare the challenges of marketing and exporting a good with those of marketing a service internationally;
- describe how the exchange of products by buyers and sellers creates a market;
- explain the factors (e.g., cultural sensitivity, appropriate packaging, logistical considerations) that contribute to the marketing plan for the export of a product;
- create advertisements for the same product that target markets in two different countries.

Effects of Technology

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe how technology has influenced the business practices (e.g., transportation,

distribution, marketing, management) of companies competing in international business;

- describe the impact of information and communication technology on international business activity;
- describe techniques and technologies that can be used by a Canadian business to export a product to another country;
- explain how e-commerce has affected the growth of international business;
- assess the potential of international markets by using data (e.g., on demographics, religion, ethnicity) obtained from a variety of sources, including the Internet.

International Careers and Skills

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- summarize a wide range of career opportunities available in international business;
- explain the effect of international business activity on jobs in Canada;
- describe the process involved in crossing international borders for international business purposes;
- demonstrate an understanding of appropriate terminology and communication techniques related to international business.

Specific Expectations

Career Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the factors that influence an individual's decision to explore work opportunities in another country (e.g., quality of life, available opportunities, working conditions, political and economic stability, salaries and benefits);
- describe the jobs in a multinational company that specifically involve international activity;
- describe work opportunities available in international businesses.

Effects of International Business on Jobs in Canada

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify occupations that have experienced increased employment in Canada in recent years as a result of the expansion of global business and those that have experienced decreased employment;
- describe how international business may influence future job opportunities and employment in Canada.

Border Issues

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify, on the basis of Internet research, the requirements for study, travel, and

employment in different countries (e.g., passports, student visas, work permits, languages, culturally appropriate behaviour);

- explain the role of the Canada Border Services Agency (e.g., facilitating legitimate cross-border traffic, supporting economic development);
- illustrate the impact of recent international events (e.g., 9/11, the outbreak of SARS in Toronto, the discovery of BSE in Canadian cattle) on Canadian international business.

Terminology and Communication Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

- define the basic terminology of international business (e.g., import, export, rationalization, outsourcing);
- demonstrate effective use of business communication techniques (e.g., in business reports, presentations, advertisements);
- use information and communication technology for a variety of purposes related to international businesses.